Lycoris radiata

Lily, Red Spider Lily, Hurricane Lily, Equinox Flower, Naked Lady, Surprise Lily

Family: Amaryllidaceae

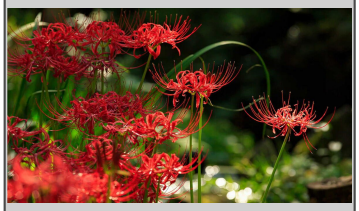
Passage N_S: 54 | Walled Garden: 106 | Wonderland: 71 | **TOTAL 231**



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Bulbous herbaceous perennial

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Height: 1–2 ft (30–60 cm) to the top of the flower scapes. Spread: 1–2 ft (30–60 cm); colonies expand by offsets. [NC State Extension] [Missouri Botanical Garden] [Gardenia]

Sun

Water

Soil
Organically rich, well-drained soils (loam, sand, chalk). Tolerates a range of pH (acid to alkaline/neutral). Medium moisture; occasionally dry. [NC State Extension] [RHS] [Missouri Botanical Garden]

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 6a–10b. Fully reliable in Atlanta Zone 8a with no special winter protection required for bulbs. Leaves emerge in fall and overwinter; this is normal and well-suited to Zone 8a winters. Best flowering occurs when summer heat is sufficient to harden the bulbs (typical in Atlanta). Naturalizes well in the Southeast, including Georgia. [NC State Extension] [Missouri Botanical Garden] [Brunswick County NC Extension]

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to China, Japan, Korea, and Nepal. Introduced and naturalized in parts of the southeastern United States (including Georgia). [NC State Extension] [Wikipedia] [Missouri Botanical Garden]

Form
Bulbous herbaceous perennial. Flowers appear on naked (leafless) scapes before foliage emerges. Habit erect; naturalizes readily by bulb offsets to form colonies. Plant type: bulb / herbaceous perennial. Growth rate: medium. [NC State Extension] [Missouri Botanical Garden] [RHS]. Also known as Hurricane Lily (blooms during hurricane season after rains), Equinox Flower, Naked Lady, Surprise Lily, Red Magic Lily. The commonly grown form is often sterile and spreads vigorously by offsets. Excellent for late-season color in mixed borders, naturalized areas, or mass plantings. [NC State Extension] [Wikipedia] [Brunswick County NC Extension]

Foliage
Basal, narrowly strap-like (linear), fleshy, grayish-green leaves with a paler central stripe. Leaves emerge in October after flowering, remain evergreen through winter, and die back in spring. [NC State Extension] [Missouri Botanical Garden] [Wikipedia] [Gardenia]

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not applicable

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant bulbs in late summer or fall with the neck at or just above soil level, spaced 6–12 in. apart. Prefers to be left undisturbed once established; naturalizes readily by offsets. Requires a well-drained site that dries somewhat in summer. In containers, use a sufficiently large pot to allow extensive root development. Propagate by division of offsets after foliage dies back. No pruning required. Store dry bulbs at 45–55 °F if lifted. [NC State Extension] [Missouri Botanical Garden] [RHS]

HEALTH

Health

No serious insect or disease problems. Generally disease-free. Occasional Narcissus bulb fly may feed on bulbs. Avoid overwatering to prevent root rot. Bulbs contain lycorine and other alkaloids and are toxic if ingested (can cause abdominal pain, vomiting, diarrhea in humans and pets). Deer resistant. Attracts butterflies and hummingbirds. [NC State Extension] [RHS] [Brunswick County NC Extension] [Gardenia]

Symptoms

None stated